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37

22%

RISE IN INDIGO'S SHARE PRICE IN 2025

Gagan Dixit, Aviation Analyst at Elara Securities, says long haul is lucrative, but Air India has the legacy advantage of slot availability at some big airports such as London's Heathrow and New York's Kennedy. "It would be tough for new entrants like IndiGo to get those," he says. Air India has not focused much on the regional international but is now remedying that via Air India Express. Under its five-year transformation plan, launched in 2022, Air India is gearing up to capture a higher share of the international sector by introducing newer aircraft, retrofitting existing

aircraft on international routes, optimising network and improving connectivity options. It has placed orders for 570 aircraft. Lazar says service levels will always differ on Air India and IndiGo in the long-haul segment as the former is a full-service carrier with all the bells and whistles.

Air India's expansion has slowed due to various reasons. CEO Campbell Wilson recently said supply chain issues at Boeing and Airbus are impacting turnaround plans. "In response, Air India is modernising existing fleet, optimising operations and working closely with manufacturers to manage delays, while staying focused on long-term global growth," says Patel.

Experts expect new dynamics to take shape once Air India and IndiGo start flying newer aircraft to the US and Europe. "It's good Indian carriers have realised that this is our market. You will see international becoming a big story," says Kaul. He says competition on international, particularly long- and ultra-long-haul segments will intensify going ahead. "The competition between IndiGo and Air India is going to be less intense than the competition from international carriers who have an interest in the market," he adds.

Opening of new international airports in Noida

